

Jose Manuel Varela Mendez

Junior Software Developer • Frontend • Backend • AI

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Portfolio: <https://jmanu02.github.io/Portafolio/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Recently graduated Systems Engineer from Universidad Fidelitas with hands-on experience in full-stack web development, REST APIs, and AI-integrated applications. Passionate about building software that solves real problems. Proactive, self-taught, and with strong communication skills demonstrated in collaborative work environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, PHP, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend: React, React Native, custom CSS, responsive design

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, JWT, bcryptjs, Zod

Databases: MongoDB (Mongoose), MySQL

AI & Automation: LLM integration (Groq API, Claude API), prompt engineering

Methodologies: Scrum (Agile)

Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Postman, GitHub Desktop, Chrome DevTools

Networking: CCNA V7 — Cisco networking fundamentals

Languages: Spanish (native), English (intermediate)

PROJECTS

CareerBot CR — AI Chatbot | Personal Project | Mar 2026 – Apr 2026

Full-stack web application that simulates an AI chat experience, using the llama-3.3-70b-versatile model via Groq API.

- Built the frontend with React + Vite, deployed on Vercel (careerbot-cr.vercel.app)
- Developed the backend with Node.js + Express with Groq API integration, deployed on Render
- Implemented environment variable management, CORS handling, and decoupled client-server architecture

Stack: React, Vite, Node.js, Express, Groq API, Vercel, Render

JWT Auth API — Secure Authentication API | Personal Project | Apr 2026

REST authentication API with JWT and refresh tokens, built as a backend portfolio piece with production-grade security standards.

- Implemented JWT + refresh token system stored in HttpOnly cookies
- Applied token rotation, MongoDB TTL-indexed blacklist, and schema validation with Zod
- Used Node.js with ES Modules, Express, Mongoose, and bcryptjs following REST best practices

Stack: Node.js, Express, MongoDB, Mongoose, JWT, Zod, bcryptjs

Academia Monka — Sports Academy Web Platform | Academic Project | May 2024 – Apr 2025

Full-stack web system for a soccer academy in Grecia, Alajuela. Built as an academic project using Scrum methodology, with management and public-facing features.

- Developed public module with player profiles, tournaments, and interactive statistical charts with filters
- Built admin panel with sessions, roles, and full player CRUD (PHP + MySQL)
- Integrated data visualizations with performance statistics charts

Stack: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, PHP, MySQL

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Systems Engineering | Universidad Fidelitas | Jan 2022 – Apr 2025

CERTIFICATIONS & COURSES

- Claude 101 — Anthropic (AI fundamentals and large language model usage)
- Claude Code in Action — Anthropic (AI-assisted development, code agents)
- CCNA V7 — Cisco Networking Academy (Networking fundamentals)